

August 12, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Odilia Feeney (MRN MUSC9777409), Claim MUSC-20260306-7670-1

Patient	Odilia Feeney (DOB 1996-06-26)
MRN	MUSC9777409
Member ID / Group	CIG732218382 / GRP-31661
Claim number	MUSC-20260306-7670-1
Date of service	2026-03-06
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	R69 — Illness, unspecified
Denied amount	\$601.05
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-10-02

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health submits this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Odilia Feeney (MRN: MUSC9777409, Member ID: CIG732218382, Group: GRP-31661) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260306-7670-1 for services rendered on March 6, 2026, at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care by James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465). Cigna Healthcare denied the claim under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115, citing a Local Coverage Determination, with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$326.74 for CPT 99214.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Feeney is a 30-year-old established patient with a documented history of care within the MUSC Health system. Her medical record reflects prior episodes of acute bronchitis and viral sinusitis coded to J06.9, a resolved concussion, and an active medication regimen that includes Natazia 28 Day Pack, ordered in May 2020 and currently active. The March 6, 2026, encounter was billed as an established outpatient office visit of moderate complexity (CPT 99214, Revenue Code 0510) at an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The primary diagnosis reported was R69 (Illness, unspecified), with J06.9 listed as a secondary diagnosis, consistent with the patient's established pattern of upper respiratory conditions.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial rests on the assertion that the documentation does not establish medical necessity for the service as billed. MUSC Health contends that this conclusion is not supported by a complete review of the clinical record. CPT 99214 describes an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring a medically appropriate history and examination with moderate medical decision-making. The selection of this level of service by Dr. Ferrell reflects his professional clinical judgment regarding the complexity of the encounter, which is consistent with the patient's active medication management and her history of recurrent upper respiratory illness. The use of R69 as the primary diagnosis, while broad, is a recognized ICD-10-CM code and does not, by itself, render a service non-covered or medically unnecessary. The secondary diagnosis of J06.9 further contextualizes the clinical presentation. Payers are expected to evaluate medical necessity based on the totality of the clinical documentation, not solely on the specificity of a diagnosis code. MUSC Health is prepared to submit the complete encounter documentation, including the physician's notes, to support the appropriateness of the visit and the level of service billed. Additionally, the patient's active prescription for Natazia 28 Day Pack requires ongoing clinical oversight, which independently supports the medical necessity of a moderate-complexity established patient visit.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare conduct a full clinical review of the supporting medical record documentation for the March 6, 2026, encounter and reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-20260306-7670-1. Specifically, we request that the claim be reprocessed and payment issued at the previously determined allowed amount of \$326.74 for CPT 99214. Should Cigna require additional clinical documentation or a peer-to-peer review with Dr. Ferrell, MUSC Health is prepared to facilitate that process promptly. This appeal is submitted in advance of the October 2, 2026, appeal deadline through the designated channels as required.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record